

on your phone after rooting. You'll also be able to install applications which need root access such as Titanium Explorer, ES File Explorer, ROM Manager, CPU Master for overclocking and so on. There's this excellent thread at Stack Exchange (<http://goo.gl/8h0Rm>) that will blow you away with the possibilities post rooting of your phone.

back up your Cydia apps separately so that they can be easily restored after you've upgraded and jailbroken your phone.

You can back up your Cydia apps by downloading OpenBackup from Cydia's official repositories. The app is quite easy to operate: simply open the app and hit the Backup button; this backs up your Cydia data to either iCloud or iTunes. You also get a local copy if you want to manually save the backup file to your computer's hard drive. You'll find the backup file at `private/var/mobile/Library/Preferences/OpenBackup-Files`, and can use iFunBox to copy the files to your hard drive.



iOS

Hacking your iOS device, on the other hand, is called jailbreaking. In an ecosystem which is under tight control by the iron-fists of the Cupertino-based giant, jailbreaking allows the user to install a modified operating system by unlocking the bootloader, sideloading third-party apps apart from those from the App Store and provide root permissions to the user.



Back up your phone

Backing up your iPhone is quite straightforward. You could either have your phone synced with iCloud or just manually create a backup from iTunes by right-clicking on your phone icon and clicking on "backup". An advantage of doing it this way is that you can restore it much faster. If you're upgrading from a jailbroken phone, make sure that you



Root your phone

As opposed to Android, not many methods are available for cracking your iPhone (infact this works for any iDevice, but we'll be limiting our discussion to the iPhones here). The table below details the various methods available for the different versions of the phone at different operating system versions.

The highlighted jailbreaks are tethered jailbreaks, i.e. you need to plug in the phone at every restart so that the jailbreak can be loaded; this patches the kernel in real time. This might sound quite cumbersome but

Jailbreaking Tools	Download Links
evasi0n	http://evasi0n.com
Greenpois0n/absinth	http://greenpois0n.com
Redsnow	http://www.redsn0w.us

it's the only way to go about doing it for the older versions of the operating systems. If you update your phone now, you'll be updated to iOS 6.1.3 and you won't be able to downgrade to 6.1.2 or lower so if you've not updated your phone you're still in luck, as you'll still be able to use evasi0n or the respective jailbreaking tool for your version of operating system. The evad3rs team is hard at work at



evasi0n in action

bringing out a jailbreak for iOS 6.1.3. Follow them on Twitter (@evad3rs) for latest updates.

These jailbreak tools are incredibly easy to operate. For e.g. consider evasi0n. Just grab the latest zip file from the tool's download page and extract the file. Make sure that you remove the lock screen password before proceeding and avoid all iTunes

related tasks when evasi0n is running. In case the process freezes at any time it's safe to restart the program and reboot the device to try the process again. To jailbreak your device just run evasi0n and click on the jailbreak button for the process to begin. Your phone will restart a couple of times during the process, be patient. Eventually, the process will run its course and you'll be able to tap on the exit button. The phone will restart and Voila! You've just jailbroken your iPhone.

Both the other apps function in a similar way. When in doubt, visit the forums on the respective app's pages, and you're bound to get help there. Make sure that you find the exact version of your firmware and use the recommended jailbreaking tool from the table above.



Access features post jailbreaking

You'll now have access to an amazing set of features which will let you modify the phone in some very interesting ways, the first of which being Cydia. This amazing little app will allow you



OpenBackup to back up your Cydia apps

Firmware Version	iPhone 5	iPhone 4	iPhone 4S	iPhone 3GS
6.0 - 6.1.2 **	evasi0n	evasi0n	evasi0n	evasi0n
5.1.1	-	absinth v2	absinth v2	absinth v2
5.1	-	Redsnow	-	Redsnow
5.0.1	-	Greenpois0n	Redsnow	Redsnow
4.3.4/5.0	-	Redsnow	-	Redsnow
4.3.3	-	Redsnow	jailbreakme.com*	Redsnow
4.3.2	-	Redsnow	-	Redsnow
4.3.1	-	Redsnow	-	Redsnow
4.3	-	-	-	-
4.2.7	-	-	-	-
4.2.1 - 4.2.6	-	Greenpois0n	-	Greenpois0n
4.0.1 - 4.1	-	Greenpois0n	-	Greenpois0n
4.0 - 4.0.1	-	jailbreakme.com*	-	jailbreakme.com*

* You just need to point Safari to this URL for this jailbreak to work

** This jailbreak won't work for users who've updated their phones to 6.1.3 which was released on 19th March